



CRT monitors offer good clarity

hand, take up more or less the same amount of space even if they are bigger in size.

Also, upgrading your monitor depends on your budget. If you can afford a 19-inch monitor, go for it: you wouldn't have to think about upgrading your monitor again for a few years. 15-inch LCDs from brands such as Acer, Digi-view and CMV cost approximately Rs 10,000, while 17-inch LCDs start from Rs 15,000, and can go up to Rs 30,000. In CRTs, 19-inch monitors start at Rs 14,000, with flat 19-inchers costing around Rs 18,000. (Check the May 2005 issue of *Digit* for more on LCD monitors.)

CRT monitors are available from well-known; however, LCDs are also available from no-name brands, and you have to watch out for these. In case of LCD monitors, check for 'dead pixels' (they don't light-up on the monitor) on the screen due to manufacturing defects. CRTs, thankfully, are free of such defects.

There's a myriad of options in brands to choose from. Aperture-grille CRT monitors offer excellent clarity, and if you can afford one, go for it. One reason you would want to opt for an aperture-grille monitor is that they are very flat. This offers extreme clarity. For more information, you can refer to the *Digit* CRT comparison in the March 2004 issue.